using precision-guided munitions, presented the Pakistani soldiers on our side of the LoC with a hopeless scenario, and a clear verdict – surrender, die or withdraw. There was just no other option, despite the tall claims made by General Musharraf and some others.

The first position of tactical importance to be captured was the Tololing peak on 13 June 1999. This feature was about five kilometres from the highway and the village of Dras, and was dominating both effectively. It fell after repeated attacks as the Pakistanis gave stiff resistance. The next prominent objective to be captured was the Tiger Hill. This battle was also well contested and the pinnacle-shaped peak was eventually captured on 4 July. There were celebrations in the Indian Army and the nation looked on with pride and awe at our achievements. It was celebration time with champagne and chocolate cake. The TV channels had galvanized the people and taken the war into every home. At a press briefing as the army spokesperson during mid-June '99, I was asked by one reporter as to when the war was likely to finish. I replied that it was the Pakistanis who initiated this conflict, but it is we who shall end it, and on our terms.

On the same day that Nawaz Sharif was in Washington, Tiger Hill was recaptured by us. Seeing the writing on the wall, he had sought an urgent meeting with President Clinton. Before Nawaz Sharif left Pakistan for the meeting, he was told by the Americans in no uncertain terms that restoration of the sanctity of the LoC as decided during the Shimla Agreement and ceasefire was 'non-negotiable and Pakistani forces would have to fall back'.[4] As events unfolded, 'the Americans bluntly told him of the seriousness of the situation, including the nuclear dimension, and he signed the joint statement'.[5] The purpose of this statement, however, was to give a veneer of face-saving to the Pakistan Army. The average citizen of Pakistan and even their armed forces, not knowing the truth, have unjustly placed the entire blame on the political leadership of their country for the withdrawal of their troops from the remaining positions in Kargil.

During the period up to 7 July, several other peaks were recaptured by our troops, such as Pt 4875 and a few more features